WHAT I WANT YOU TO KNOW

A Ritual of Emotional Transparency and Connection (20 minutes)

Purpose: To share something true that's been living quietly inside you — a thought, realization, or desire you want your partner to understand. This isn't a repair conversation or a problem to solve. It's a moment to bring forward something meaningful, hopeful, or alive in you.

Tone: Warm. Honest. Playful when it fits. No defensiveness, no fixing. Just presence.

Setup: 20 minutes total. Each partner gets 10 minutes. One person speaks while the other listens and reflects.

⇢ Step 1 – The Share (5–7 minutes)

Speak directly from your experience. You're not analyzing or negotiating — you're letting your partner see something you've been carrying.

Prompts you can draw from:

"What I want you to know is…"
"I've been thinking about…"
"I've realized…"
"I've been wanting to tell you…"
"I think I might be ready to…"
"It matters to me because…"

Example language:

⇢ *I've been thinking about how much I still love discovering new parts of you — even after all this time.*

⇢ *I've been craving more play between us. I miss our sense of fun.*

⇢ *I finally feel ready to talk about planning that trip we always said we'd take.*

⇢ *I keep imagining us getting away somewhere totally quiet — no plans, no pressure, just us.*

⇢ *I think I'm ready to try that thing you brought up a few years ago — the one I wasn't open to yet.*

⇢ *When you touch me lately, I feel myself coming alive again.*

⇢ *I've been thinking about learning something new together — maybe cooking, dancing, let's shake up our rhythm.*

⇢ *I notice how much I still want to impress you — that still matters to me.*

⇢ *I've been thinking about our future — not just stability, but adventure. I want to build more stories with you.*

⇢ *I've been wanting to tell you how seen I feel when you really listen — it changes everything for me.*

⇢ *I've realized that I want to bring more boldness back into how we love — more laughter, more skin, more risk.*

⇢ *I've been imagining us doing something completely out of character, just to remember that we still can.*

⇢ *I've been reflecting on how far we've come, and how much I want to keep choosing this, choosing us.*

⇢ *I've noticed I'm softer with you lately — I think it's because I finally feel safe again.*

⇢ Step 2 – The Reflection (3–5 minutes)

The listener reflects what they heard — not to respond, but to honor.

"*You want me to know that you've been feeling…"*

"You've been thinking about…"

"You're ready for…"

"You're opening to…"

"That means something to you because…"

⇢ Step 3 – The Closing (1 minute)

End the conversation with something grounding and true:

"I feel lighter saying that."

"I'm glad I shared it."

"Thanks for listening."

"I feel closer to you now."

"I'm excited for what comes next."

Guiding Reminder

This isn't a place for repair or feedback. It's a space to speak what's alive in you — affection, curiosity, longing, or growth. When you name what's true before it fades, connection stays vibrant, not habitual.

COUPLE FORWARD